India & Romania: Bridging Nations, Building Prosperity

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October 2026

FOREWORD

India and Romania share a growing economic relationship shaped by expanding trade, emerging investment opportunities and increasing interest among businesses in both markets. Romania's position within the European economic landscape, combined with India's expanding industrial and services capabilities, creates significant scope for deeper commercial engagement across sectors. Strengthening these linkages can support greater market access, technology cooperation, investment partnerships and enterprise-level collaboration.

For Indian businesses, Romania offers opportunities across areas including information technology, automotive and components, pharmaceuticals, engineering, energy, infrastructure and other emerging sectors. At the same time, Romanian enterprises can benefit from India's large and diversified market, expanding industrial ecosystem, skilled talent base and growing demand for advanced products and services. Realising this potential, however, requires reliable market intelligence, stronger institutional connections and practical mechanisms that can help businesses identify and pursue credible opportunities.

This paper seeks to provide a structured perspective on the India–Romania economic relationship, with particular attention to trade potential, priority sectors, market-entry considerations, business matchmaking and institutional cooperation. It also examines practical mechanisms through which industry-led engagement can be strengthened, enabling enterprises to move from identifying opportunities to establishing meaningful commercial partnerships.

CCI India can play an important role as a facilitator, connector and knowledge partner by bringing together businesses, industry associations and relevant institutions from both countries. Through targeted B2B matchmaking, business delegations, sector-focused dialogues, market intelligence and investment facilitation, CCI India can contribute to creating a more accessible and predictable environment for bilateral business engagement.

We hope this paper will serve as a useful reference for policymakers, industry leaders, investors and enterprises seeking to understand and engage with the India–Romania economic opportunity. CCI India remains committed to strengthening international business partnerships and supporting greater trade, investment and enterprise cooperation between India and Romania.



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TABLE OF CONTENT

FOREWORD **1**

ROMANIA 5

1. COUNTRY PROFILE OF ROMANIA **8**

1.1 GEOGRAPHY 8
1.2 DEMOGRAPHICS 8
1.3 POLITICAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE SYSTEM 9
1.4 ECONOMIC PROFILE 10
1.5 INTERNATIONAL POSITION 11
1.6 MAJOR CITIES: BUSINESS-ORIENTED PROFILES 11

2. ROMANIA'S ECONOMIC LANDSCAPE **12**

2.1 EVOLUTION AND STRUCTURAL PROFILE 12
2.2 CONSUMER MARKET, LABOUR MARKET AND PRODUCTIVITY 13
2.3 DIGITALISATION, INFRASTRUCTURE AND EU FUNDING 13
2.4 FDI ENVIRONMENT AND INDUSTRIAL COMPETITIVENESS 13

3. MAJOR ECONOMIC SECTORS **13**

3.1 AUTOMOTIVE 13
3.2 IT AND DIGITAL ECONOMY 14
3.3 ENERGY (OIL, GAS, NUCLEAR, HYDROPOWER) 15
3.4 AGRICULTURE AND FOOD PROCESSING 16
3.5 MANUFACTURING (MACHINERY, ELECTRONICS, ELECTRICAL EQUIPMENT, ENGINEERING) 16
3.6 PHARMACEUTICALS AND HEALTHCARE 17
3.7 AEROSPACE AND DEFENCE 17
3.8 CONSTRUCTION AND INFRASTRUCTURE 18
3.9 LOGISTICS AND TRANSPORTATION 18
3.10 CHEMICALS 19
3.11 TEXTILES AND APPAREL 19
3.12 TOURISM 20
3.13 RENEWABLE ENERGY AND GREEN TECHNOLOGY 20

4. INDIA–ROMANIA DIPLOMATIC RELATIONS **21**

4.1 HISTORICAL RELATIONSHIP AND EVOLUTION 21
4.2 GOVERNMENT ENGAGEMENT AND INSTITUTIONAL COOPERATION 22
4.3 EDUCATION, SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND DEFENCE 22

5. EMBASSIES AND INSTITUTIONAL PRESENCE **23**

5.1 EMBASSY OF ROMANIA IN INDIA 23
5.2 EMBASSY OF INDIA IN BUCHAREST 23

6. INDIA–ROMANIA TRADE RELATIONS **24**

6.1 OVERVIEW 24

7. TRADE STATISTICS AND TRENDS **24**

7.1 ANALYSIS OF THE TRENDS 24
7.2 THE ROMANIAN VIEW OF THE SAME TRADE 25

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8. MAJOR PRODUCTS TRADED 25

8.1 INDIA'S MAJOR EXPORTS TO ROMANIA 25
8.2 ROMANIA'S MAJOR EXPORTS TO INDIA 25

9. MAJOR TRADE OPPORTUNITIES 25

10. MAJOR CHALLENGES FACING INDIA–ROMANIA BUSINESS COOPERATION 27

11. CHALLENGE → INDIAN OPPORTUNITY → CCI INDIA RESPONSE 28

12. CCI INDIA STRATEGIC ROLE 29

12.1 CONNECT 29
12.2 FACILITATE 30
12.3 SCALE 30

13. SECTOR-WISE CCI INDIA CONTRIBUTION 31

13.1 AUTOMOTIVE & EV 31
13.2 IT & AI 31
13.3 PHARMACEUTICALS 32
13.4 AGRICULTURE & FOOD PROCESSING 32
13.5 RENEWABLE ENERGY 32
13.6 ENGINEERING & MANUFACTURING 32
13.7 LOGISTICS 33
13.8 INFRASTRUCTURE 33
13.9 HEALTHCARE 33
13.10 STARTUPS 34
13.11 MSMES 34
13.12 AEROSPACE/DEFENCE 34

14. PROPOSED CCI INDIA INITIATIVES 34

14.1 INDIA–ROMANIA BUSINESS COUNCIL 35
14.2 ROMANIA DESK AT CCI INDIA 35
14.3 INDIA–ROMANIA SME CONNECT 35
14.4 INDIA–ROMANIA STARTUP BRIDGE 35
14.5 INDIA–ROMANIA TECHNOLOGY FORUM 36
14.6 INDIA–ROMANIA INVESTMENT FORUM 36
14.7 INDIA–ROMANIA FOOD & AGRICULTURE FORUM 36
14.8 INDIA–ROMANIA RENEWABLE ENERGY FORUM 36
14.9 INDIA–ROMANIA AUTOMOTIVE & EV FORUM 37
14.10 INDIA–ROMANIA ANNUAL BUSINESS SUMMIT 37
14.11 EU MARKET ENTRY SUPPORT PROGRAMME 37
14.12 ROMANIAN BUSINESS PARTNER NETWORK 37
14.13 INDIA–ROMANIA INNOVATION FORUM 37

15. BUSINESS MATCHMAKING AND TRADE PROMOTION FRAMEWORK 38

15.1 FRAMEWORK COMPONENTS 38

17. POTENTIAL ROMANIAN STAKEHOLDERS 39

18. BUSINESS DELEGATION OPPORTUNITIES 40

Delegation 1: Automotive & EV *40*
Delegation 2: IT, AI & Digital Economy *41*

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Delegation 3: Renewable Energy 41
Delegation 4: Agriculture & Food Processing 41
Delegation 5: Pharmaceuticals & Healthcare 42
Delegation 6: Manufacturing & Engineering 42

19. STARTUP AND SME COOPERATION 43

19.1 ECOSYSTEM OVERVIEW 43
19.2 INDIA–ROMANIA STARTUP BRIDGE FRAMEWORK 43
19.3 SME COOPERATION 44

21. CONCLUSION 45

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ROMANIA

> Explore castles, countryside, and folklore through authentic local experiences.



Basic Facts and Economic Overview

Romania is a large country in Eastern Europe, with Bucharest as its capital. As of 2025 projections, Romania's population is approximately 18.5–19 million. The country is a semi-presidential republic and a member of the European Union, NATO, and the United Nations.

Romania is an high-income economy economy with a rapidly growing industrial and services sector. Key industries include automotive manufacturing, IT services, agriculture, energy, and construction. The country has emerged as one of Europe's fastest-growing economies in recent years.

Economy — GDP, Structure & Recent Performance

Romania's nominal GDP is estimated at approximately USD 428.7 billion (2025).

- Sectoral Composition:Services: ~62–63%
- Industry: ~25%
- Agriculture: ~3–4%

Romania has experienced strong economic growth, averaging 3–4% annually, driven by industrial expansion, IT services, and domestic consumption.

Bilateral Trade with India

Trade between India and Romania is growing, estimated at approximately USD 1.45 billion annually (2024–25).

India exports pharmaceuticals, textiles, and machinery, while importing industrial products and chemicals.

Population & Currency

Romania has a population of approximately 19 million, with significant urban centers including Bucharest, Cluj-Napoca, and Timișoara.

The official currency is the Romanian Leu (RON), which operates under a managed float system.



Cultural and Heritage

The culture and heritage of Romania are shaped by a blend of Latin, Slavic, and Balkan influences. Romania is known for its rich folklore, traditional music, colorful festivals, and beautifully preserved villages. Historic castles, monasteries, and medieval towns reflect the country's deep history and architectural beauty. Traditional crafts such as pottery, weaving, and wood carving remain an important part of Romanian heritage. The country also values family traditions, local cuisine, and cultural celebrations that have been passed down through generations.

Import and Export from India

Romania imports pharmaceuticals, textiles, machinery, chemicals, and consumer goods, some of which originate from India either directly or through European supply chains. Direct exports from Romania to India include industrial products, machinery, and agricultural goods, with additional trade routed through global networks.

Strategic Importance and Key Observation

India and Romania share long-standing and friendly relations, with growing cooperation across trade, education, and technology sectors. Romania's strategic location in Eastern Europe and its integration within the European Union make it an important partner for India's outreach to regional markets. Collaboration is further strengthened through academic exchanges, IT services, and industrial partnerships, reflecting a steadily expanding and mutually beneficial relationship.

Opportunities and Risks for Indian Businesses

Opportunities:

- IT and digital services
- Manufacturing and automotive
- Pharmaceuticals and healthcare

Risks:

- Regulatory complexities
- Dependence on EU economic conditions
- Infrastructure gaps in certain regions



Cultural and Strategic Economic Ties

India and Romania share long-standing relations, with growing cooperation across trade, education, and technology sectors. Bilateral ties have been strengthened through regular diplomatic engagement and expanding economic interaction, particularly in areas such as IT services, engineering, and manufacturing. Academic exchanges and skill development initiatives further support the partnership, reflecting a steady and mutually beneficial relationship.

Conclusion – Summary & Recommendation

Romania is a high-growth emerging European economy with strong industrial and IT potential, supported by a skilled workforce and competitive production environment. India should focus on expanding bilateral trade, particularly in engineering goods, pharmaceuticals, and IT services, while encouraging investments in manufacturing and industrial partnerships. Additionally, leveraging Romania's strategic position within the European Union can help Indian businesses use it as an effective entry point into wider EU markets.

1. Country Profile of Romania

1.1 Geography

Location, borders and Black Sea access

Romania is the largest country in south-eastern Europe, with an area of 238,397 km² on the western coast of the Black Sea. It borders Ukraine, Moldova, Hungary, Serbia and Bulgaria. The Black Sea coast, with the port of Constanța, provides a maritime outlet for trade with the Caucasus, Central Asia and the Middle East, and the Danube gives an inland-waterway link into central Europe.

Major geographical regions

Romania's landscape is organised around the Carpathian Mountains, which enclose the Transylvanian Plateau in the centre and north-west, with the Moldavian plateau to the east, and the Wallachian and Danubian plains to the south, ending in the Danube Delta at the Black Sea. These physical regions broadly correspond to distinct economic clusters: Transylvania and the west (IT, automotive, electronics), the south (Bucharest, industry, services), the south-east (ports and energy) and the north-east (universities, agriculture, emerging IT).

Strategic location within Europe

Romania is a member of the EU and, since 1 January 2025, of the Schengen area including land borders. It lies on the EU's eastern flank, adjacent to Ukraine and Moldova, and was a transit country for Indian nationals evacuated from Ukraine in 2022, when the Romanian government eased entry requirements.

1.2 Demographics

INS provisional data show a resident population of **19.041 million** on 1 January 2026, 1,829 fewer than a year earlier. Natural population change was negative (−104,100) for the 34th consecutive year, while net international migration was positive (+102,200), making Romania a net immigration country in 2025. The urban resident population was 9.792 million.

Indicator	Value
Resident population, 1 Jan 2026	19.041 million
Natural population change, 2025	−104,100
Net international migration, 2025	+102,200
Urban resident population, 1 Jan 2026	9.792 million (about 51%)
Population aged 65+, 1 Jan 2026	20.5%
Ageing index, 1 Jan 2026	135.9 persons 65+ per 100 under 15
Unemployment rate, Q2 2025	6.3% (5.3% a year earlier)

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Indicator	Value
Minimum gross monthly wage, 2025	RON 4,050 (about €810)
Average gross monthly wage, early 2026	about RON 7,200 (about €1,440)

Workforce, education and skills

Reliable, current, sourced data on labour-force size, tertiary attainment and ICT specialist employment could not be independently verified in this pass and will be added from Eurostat and INS. Qualitative indicators relevant to India: Romania hosts around 224 Indian students, mainly in medicine, agricultural sciences and veterinary medicine, at institutions in Timișoara, Oradea, Bucharest and Iași, and an Indian community of about 13,500, including approximately 10,000 workers. Two Indian studies centres exist at Babeș-Bolyai University (Cluj) and the Romanian-American University (Bucharest).

Implications

A shrinking, ageing population and rising wages point to labour-supply constraints in Romanian industry. That is already visible in the increase in Indian workers joining construction and other sectors , and it creates openings for automation, technology and workforce-solutions partnerships.

1.3 Political and Administrative System

Romania is a semi-presidential republic. The President, currently Nicușor Dan, is head of state and is directly elected; the Prime Minister leads the government; Parliament is bicameral, with a Senate and a Chamber of Deputies. Ilie Bolojan was reported as Prime Minister in July 2026 , but the EC's May 2026 forecast also cites domestic political uncertainty , so office-holders should be re-checked immediately before publication of the final version.

Administratively, Romania is divided into 41 counties plus the Municipality of Bucharest, with eight development regions used for statistical and EU-funding purposes (general reference knowledge. Relevant economic institutions include the Ministry of Economy, Digitalisation, Entrepreneurship and Tourism, which co-leads the India–Romania Joint Economic Committee , the National Bank of Romania, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, and the national investment and trade promotion bodies.

Romania also places growing emphasis on digital governance, regional development and decentralised public services, with EU-funded programmes supporting infrastructure, innovation, SME development and digital transformation across its regions.

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